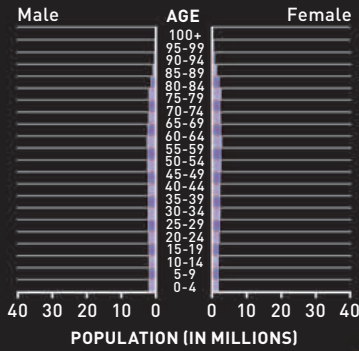


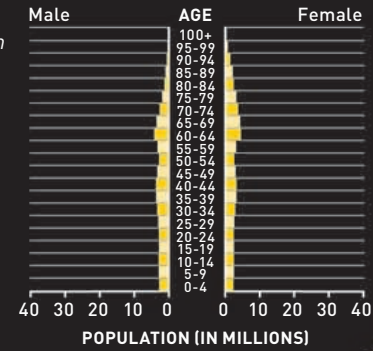
GERMANY

Germany reacted to the union of East and West Germany by becoming the largest economy on the European continent, and the fifth wealthiest in the world by GDP. Germany is the world's second-largest trader in imports and exports.



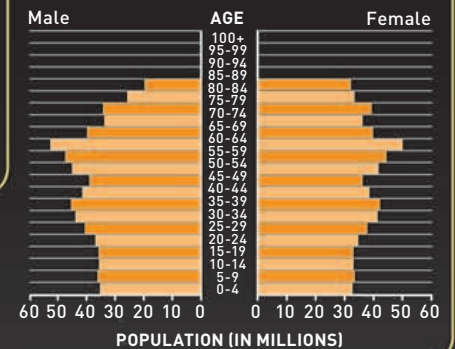
RUSSIA

The world's largest country, Russia, has seen huge changes since the fall of the Soviet Union. It has vast natural resources, such as oil and gas, and is the world's largest oil producer, but many Russian people still live in poverty.



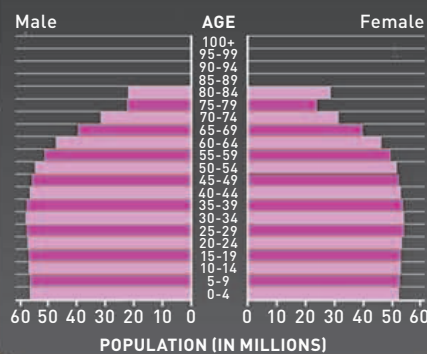
CHINA

China, the world's most populated country, has one of the fastest-growing economies and is the top exporter. Factories and mines produce most of China's wealth, but in the future this may be slowed by an aging population.



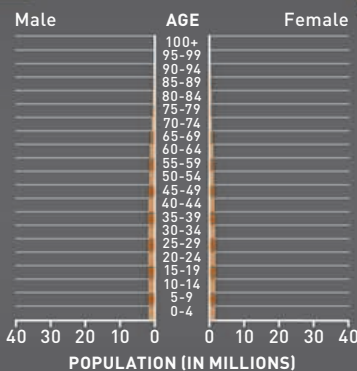
INDIA

It is estimated that India's economy will grow faster than any other country's over the next two decades. It has a young and growing workforce, has opened up foreign trade, and hosts millions of entrepreneurs running small, but successful, businesses.



SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa has one of the largest economies on the African continent, but poverty is widespread. One in seven people is infected with HIV/AIDS, high crime and land redistribution remain an issue, and unemployment is high.



AUSTRALIA

Australia's economy stands out because it survived the global downturn without going into recession. It has a strong service-providing economy as well as healthy exports of agriculture and mining products. Natural gas deposits are evenly spread throughout the continent.

